

African
Brain
Data
Network

Module 3 Scientific Writing

Publishing a paper

30 September 2026 - Fonso Pica



Review: synthesis matrix

Complete a synthesis matrix for 3-5 references

Try to identify 2 research gaps



Outline

- Choosing a journal
- Submission checklist
- Peer-review process
- AfricaArXiv
- Suggested exercise:
Journal selection and reviewer questions



Choosing a journal

1. Make a list of candidate journals

Which journals have published research on your subject area?

Speak to colleagues and supervisors

Journal suggester tools: [JANE](#), [Taylor & Francis](#), [Elsevier](#)

Guides from [PLOS](#) and [Taylor & Francis](#)

Demo: Jane

New Results

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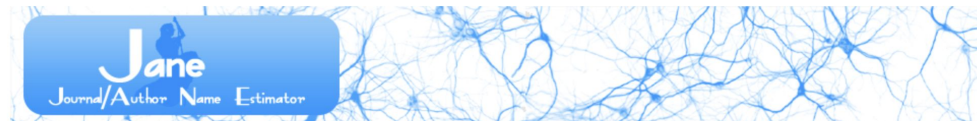
Ongoing brain state dynamics shape spontaneous awake reactivation and its relationship with memory

Hyun-Woong Kim, Ting Xu, Karl-Heinz Nenning, Alexandre R Franco, Mark D'Esposito, Stanley Colcombe, Michael Milham,  Arielle Tambini

doi: <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.09.24.754200>

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Insert your title and/or abstract here: (or, click [here](#) to search using keywords)

Memory reactivation is thought to support memory consolidation, but how ongoing brain states shape awake reactivation and its relationship to memory remain poorly understood. Here, we asked whether spontaneous hippocampal-cortical reactivation during awake rest is embedded in ongoing brain state dynamics by examining its coupling with whole-brain activity patterns and infra-slow global signal (GS) fluctuations, and whether these dynamics shape its relationship to memory retention. Reactivation preferentially occurred during an internally oriented brain state characterized by default mode network activation and dorsal attention network suppression, as well as states that reinstated encoding-related visual activity. Reactivation also clustered around the peak of infra-slow GS fluctuations and in high GS amplitude time windows, features previously associated with lower arousal. Importantly, the relationship between reactivation and memory depended on the ongoing brain state: distinct whole-brain activity patterns expressed during reactivation were associated with opposing memory outcomes, while reactivation during high GS amplitude windows was positively associated with retention. Together, these findings show that awake memory reactivation is embedded in dynamic whole-brain states that may influence its memory outcome, suggesting that recurring brain states may provide favorable windows for awake memory consolidation.

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Have you recently written a paper, but you're not sure to which journal you should submit it? Or maybe you want to find relevant articles to cite in your paper? Or are you an editor, and do you need to find reviewers for a particular paper? Jane can help!

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Instead of using a title or abstract, you can also search using a keyword search, similar to popular web search engines. Click [here](#) to search using keywords.

Beware of predatory journals

JANE relies on the data in PubMed, which can contain papers from predatory journals, and therefore these journals can appear in JANE's results. To help identify high-quality journals, JANE now tags journals that are currently indexed in MEDLINE, and open access journals approved by the Directory of Open Access Journals (DOAJ).

[Additional information about Jane](#)

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Demo: Jane



These journals have articles most similar to your input:
"Memory reactivation is thought to support memory consolidation, but how ongoing brain states shape a..."

Confidence	Journal	Article Influence	Articles
	J Neurosci Medline-indexed PMC	2.8	Show articles
	Scientific reports High-quality open access Medline-indexed PMC	1.9	Show articles
	Nature communications High-quality open access Medline-indexed PMC	5.5	Show articles
	bioRxiv : the preprint server for biology		Show articles
	Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America Medline-indexed PMC	4.7	Show articles
	NeuroImage High-quality open access Medline-indexed	2.3	Show articles
	Philos Trans R Soc Lond B Biol Sci Medline-indexed PMC	3.2	Show articles
	Cell reports High-quality open access Medline-indexed	4.9	Show articles
	Sleep Medline-indexed PMC	1.9	Show articles
	Cerebral cortex (New York, N.Y. : 1991) Medline-indexed PMC	3.4	Show articles
	Communications biology High-quality open access PMC		Show articles
	Neural computation Medline-indexed	0.9	Show articles
	The Journal of physiology Medline-indexed PMC	1.8	Show articles
	Clin Neurophysiol Medline-indexed	1.1	Show articles
	Neurobiology of learning and memory Medline-indexed	1.2	Show articles
	Current opinion in behavioral sciences		Show articles
	Annals of clinical and translational neurology High-quality open access Medline-indexed PMC		Show articles
	Imaging neuroscience (Cambridge, Mass.) High-quality open access PMC		Show articles
	Epilepsy & behavior : E&B Medline-indexed	0.7	Show articles
	iScience High-quality open access PMC		Show articles
	eLife High-quality open access Medline-indexed PMC	5.6	Show articles
	Neuroscience Medline-indexed	1.0	Show articles
	eNeuro High-quality open access Medline-indexed PMC		Show articles
	Neurobiology of language (Cambridge, Mass.) High-quality open access PMC		Show articles
	Network neuroscience (Cambridge, Mass.) High-quality open access PMC		Show articles

Medline-indexed

This journal is currently indexed in MEDLINE, so was reviewed by NLM at some point in time. However, authors should assess the journals listed to ensure they are not predatory.

Source: *The National Library of Medicine*

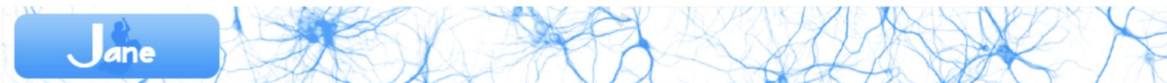
Article Influence

The Article Influence (AI) measures how often articles in the journal are cited within the first five years after its publication. These citations are weighted based the influence of the journals from which citations are received: being cited in an article in Science can boost a journal's AI more than being cited in an article in an obscure journal.

The blue bar indicates the percentage of journals in Medline that has a lower AI score.

Source: *eigenfactor.org*

Demo: Jane



These journals have articles most similar to your input:

"Memory reactivation is thought to support memory consolidation, but how ongoing brain states shape a..."

Confidence	Journal	Article Influence	Articles
J Neurosci Medline-indexed PMC		2.8	Hide articles

The confidence score for **J Neurosci** is based on these articles:

Similarity	Citation
	Tang, W, Shin, JD, Frank, LM, Jadhav, SP Hippocampal-Prefrontal Reactivation during Learning Is Stronger in Awake Compared with Sleep States. J Neurosci. 2017
	Väyrynen, T, Helakari, H, Korhonen, V, Tuunainen, J, Huotari, N, Kananen, J, Ebrahimi, SM, Elabasy, A, Järvelä, M, Hautamäki, K, Laurén, K, Raitamaa, L, Salmi, U, Piispala, J, Kallio, M, Kiviniemi, V Infra-slow (<0.1 Hz) Modulation of Human Brain Pulsations in Awake and Sleep States. J Neurosci. 2026
	Bang, JW, Sasaki, Y, Watanabe, T, Rahnev, D Feature-Specific Awake Reactivation in Human V1 after Visual Training. J Neurosci. 2018
	Farrens, AJ, Vahdat, S, Serdj, F Changes in Resting State Functional Connectivity Associated with Dynamic Adaptation of Wrist Movements. J Neurosci. 2023
	Becker, R, Van de Ville, D, Kleinschmidt, A Alpha Oscillations Reduce Temporal Long-Range Dependence in Spontaneous Human Brain Activity. J Neurosci. 2018
	Wei, Y, Krishnan, GP, Marshall, L, Martinetz, T, Bazhenov, M Stimulation Augments Spike Sequence Replay and Memory Consolidation during Slow-Wave Sleep. J Neurosci. 2020

[Explore more in PubMed](#)



Choosing a journal

2. Review the candidate list

Review the journal's aims and scope

Is your research relevant for journal's audience?

Is your work too similar to other articles in the journal?

Is your manuscript format appropriate?

Check editorial policies and peer review process



Article access

- Traditional / Subscription model
- Gold Open Access
- Green Open Access
- Hybrid Journals / Open select

Open access allows more people to see your work

Some funders / institutions require open access

Learn more about [open access](#), doaj.org

Open research aims to open all scholarly output, e.g. f1000research.com



Journal metrics

Aim to measure the performance and impact of a journal

- Citation metrics
 - Impact factor
 - Altmetric attention score
 - H-index
- Speed metrics
- Discoverability

Consider different metrics for better picture

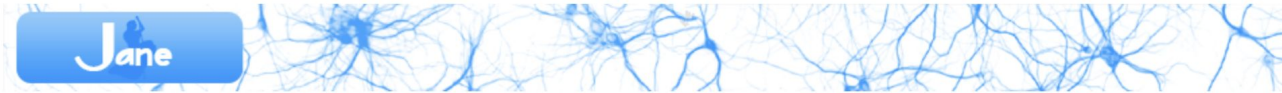
Impact factors are relative, compare within field

Read more about [journal metrics](#)

Discoverability

Journals that are indexed well are easy to find in databases

- Google scholar, Web of Science, PubMed, DOAJ



These journals have articles most similar to your input:

"Memory reactivation is thought to support memory consolidation, but how ongoing brain states shape a..."

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	bioRxiv : the preprint server for biology		Show articles
	Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America Medline-indexed PMC	4.7	Show articles
	NeuroImage High-quality open access Medline-indexed	2.3	Show articles
	Philos Trans R Soc Lond B Biol Sci Medline-indexed PMC	3.2	Show articles

Medline-indexed

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Source: *The National Library of Medicine*



Impact factor vs. audience

Should you prioritise journal that attracts a more appropriate audience?

To consider, picking journal with appropriate audience can:

1. Increase the chances that your work is read by appropriate reviewers
2. Increase the chances that your work gets cited

Bottom line: don't focus on a single metric



Choosing a journal

3. Make sure you can trust the journal

Beware predatory journals & publishers

- Is the peer review process clearly described?
- Is the editorial board listed?
- Is the journal indexed in databases like PubMed or Web of Science?

thinkchecksubmit.org checklist to pick trustworthy journal

Check doaj.org for trusted open access journals

Demo: Think. Check. Submit.

! THINK

Are you submitting your research to a trusted journal?

Is it the right journal for your work?

- More research is being published worldwide.
- New publishers are launched each week.
- Many researchers have concerns about **predatory publishing**.
- It can be challenging to find up-to-date guidance when choosing where to publish.

✓ INTERACTIVE CHECKLIST

Question 1 of 7 0% complete

~2 min check

KNOWLEDGE PUBLISHER PEER REVIEW INDEXING FEES GUIDELINES MEMBERSHIP

KNOWLEDGE - 1/7

Do you or your colleagues know the journal?

Search ISSN Portal [↗](#)

Yes

No

Not Sure

← Back

Continue →

✓ CHECK

Reference this list for your chosen journal to check if it is trusted.

Do you or your colleagues know the journal?

- ☐ Have you read any articles in the journal before?
- ☐ Is it easy to discover the latest papers in the journal?
- ☐ Name of the journal: the name is unique; it is not the same or easily confused with another journal.
- ☐ Can you cross check with information about the journal in the [ISSN portal](#)?

Can you easily identify and contact the publisher?

- ☐ Is the publisher name clearly displayed on the journal website?
- ☐ Can you contact the publisher by telephone, email, and post?

Note: not full list

➔ SUBMIT

If you have been able to check most or all of the items on the list.

Complete the checklist and submit your manuscript only if you can answer 'yes' to most or all of the questions above.



Submission checklist

Prepare your paper for submission

- Review instructions for authors
- Anonymize paper (if required)
- Write cover letter
- Check formatting
- Select keywords
- [ORCID](#)



Submission checklist

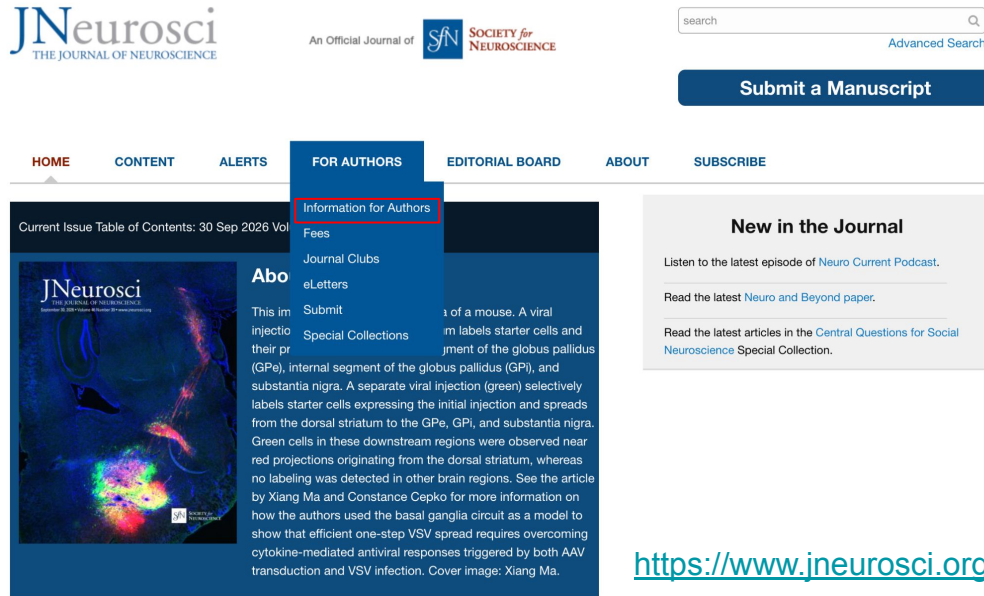
Review instructions for authors

1. Information about the journal e.g. types of articles
2. Article guides e.g. word count, style guides, formatting, templates
3. Manuscript submission process e.g. which submission system you should use
4. Specific policies e.g. ethics compliance, code and data sharing
5. Publishing options e.g. open access

Read more [here](#)

Example: author instructions

Review instructions for authors



The screenshot displays the JNeurosci website interface. At the top left is the JNeurosci logo with the tagline 'THE JOURNAL OF NEUROSCIENCE'. To its right, it states 'An Official Journal of' followed by the Society for Neuroscience logo. A search bar with the text 'search' and a magnifying glass icon is located to the right of the logo, with a link to 'Advanced Search' below it. A prominent blue button labeled 'Submit a Manuscript' is positioned below the search bar. The main navigation bar includes links for HOME, CONTENT, ALERTS, FOR AUTHORS, EDITORIAL BOARD, ABOUT, and SUBSCRIBE. The 'FOR AUTHORS' menu is expanded, showing a list of links: Information for Authors (highlighted with a red box), Fees, Journal Clubs, eLetters, Submit, Special Collections, and a link to a paper about a viral injection in a mouse. On the left side of the page, there is a section for the 'Current Issue Table of Contents: 30 Sep 2026 Vol' featuring a cover image of the journal and a brief description of the content. On the right side, there is a 'New in the Journal' section with links to the latest episode of the Neuro Current Podcast, the latest Neuro and Beyond paper, and the latest articles in the Central Questions for Social Neuroscience Special Collection. At the bottom left, there is a small logo for 'African Brain Data Network'.

JNeurosci
THE JOURNAL OF NEUROSCIENCE

An Official Journal of **SfN** SOCIETY for NEUROSCIENCE

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- Special Collections

Current Issue Table of Contents: 30 Sep 2026 Vol

JNeurosci
THE JOURNAL OF NEUROSCIENCE

Abo

This im
injectio
their pr
(GPe), internal segment of the globus pallidus (GPI), and substantia nigra. A separate viral injection (green) selectively labels starter cells expressing the initial injection and spreads from the dorsal striatum to the GPe, GPI, and substantia nigra. Green cells in these downstream regions were observed near red projections originating from the dorsal striatum, whereas no labeling was detected in other brain regions. See the article by Xiang Ma and Constance Cepko for more information on how the authors used the basal ganglia circuit as a model to show that efficient one-step VSV spread requires overcoming cytokine-mediated antiviral responses triggered by both AAV transduction and VSV infection. Cover image: Xiang Ma.

New in the Journal

Listen to the latest episode of [Neuro Current Podcast](#).

Read the latest [Neuro and Beyond](#) paper.

Read the latest articles in the [Central Questions for Social Neuroscience](#) Special Collection.

<https://www.jneurosci.org/>

Example: author instructions

Review instructions for authors

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Information for Authors

Updated September 2026

Authors can publish in *JNeurosci* and still be in compliance with the NIH Public Access Policy. Read the details [here](#).

General Information

- Mission
- Types of Articles

Policies

- Policy on Ethics
- Policies on the Use of Animals and Humans in Neuroscience Research
- Policy on Prepublication
- Policy on Molecular Data
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- Policy on Image Manipulation
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- Policy Concerning Availability of Materials and Data

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- Feature Pre-Approval

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- Review Transfer

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- Revisions
- Proofs
- Cover Art

Fees

Post-Publication Information

- NIH Public Access Policy
- Early Release
- Media and Embargo Policies
- Errata
- Retractions

Contact Information

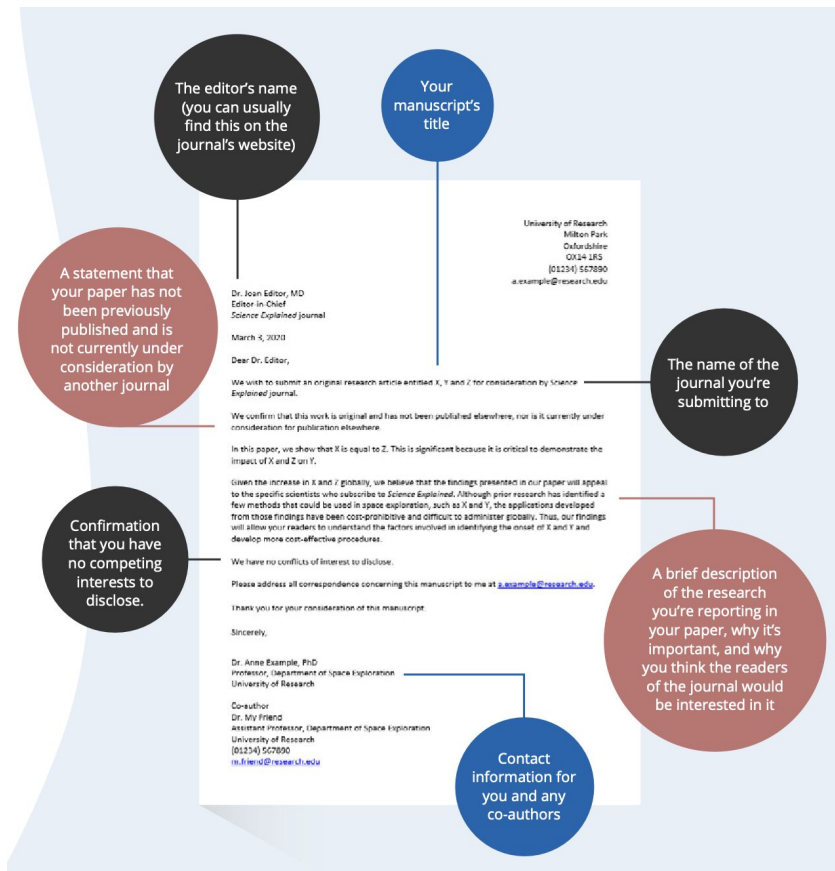
<https://www.jneurosci.org/content/information-authors>

Submission checklist

Cover letter

Opportunity to sell your research

Make sure to address journal aim and scope



[Article submission and peer-review guide, Taylor & Francis](#)

[Download cover letter template](#)



Submission checklist

ORCiD

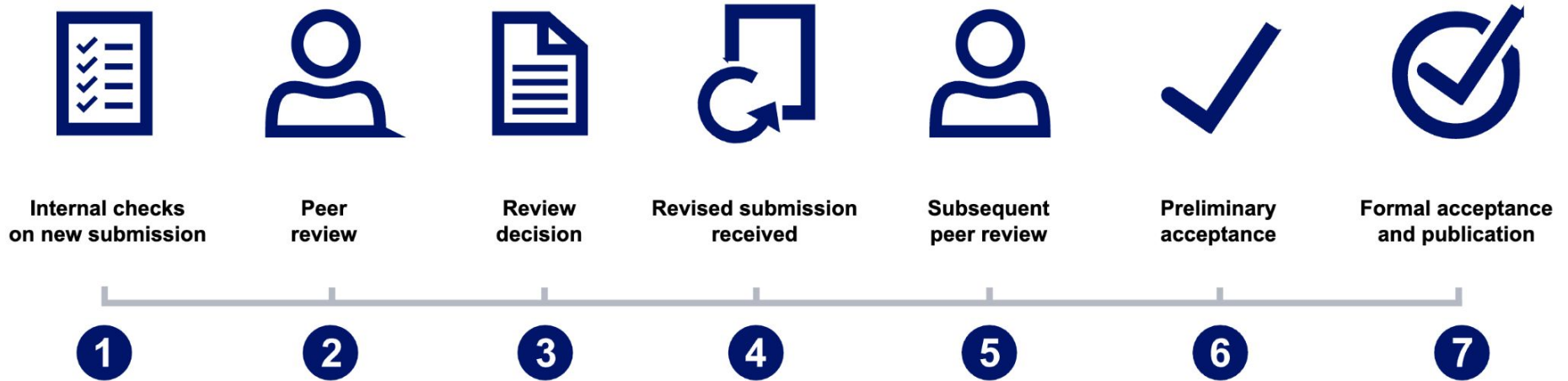
Digital identifier that distinguishes you from every other researcher

It makes sure you and your research activities can be easily identified

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[Read more](#) on how to use your ORCiD

Peer review process



[Understanding the publication process, PLOS](#)



Peer review types

- **Single-Blind:** reviewers know author identities, but reviewers are anonymous. (Most common).
- **Double-Blind:** authors and reviewers are anonymous
- **Open Review:** reviewer reports and reviewer names are published alongside the article.



Peer review outcome

- **Desk Reject (No Review):** The editor decides the manuscript does not fit the scope or novelty threshold. (Saves time and allows immediate re-submission elsewhere).
- **Reject (After Review):** Fatal flaws in methodology, unsupported conclusions, or insufficient interest.
- **Major Revision:** The paper has merit, but requires substantial new experiments, analyses, or restructuring. (Does not guarantee final acceptance).
- **Minor Revision:** Small clarifications, textual edits, or additional control explanations required. (High probability of acceptance).
- **Accept:** Ready for production.



Responding to peer review

Manage emotional reactions

- Assume reviewers have good intentions
- Feedback verifies and strengthens your work
- Take your time to process the outcome (stay calm)

Some tips:

1. Make a plan and stick to it
2. Sort requests to prioritize your work, but address all points
3. Do not ignore comments; if you did not make a change explain why
4. Have a system for responding to each comment and highlight your edits (see next slide)
5. Let your editor know if you need time to do extra experiments

[Responding to peer review, PLOS](#)

Example: strategy for responding to reviewers

1. **Be Complete & Polite:** Thank the editor and reviewers for their time. Answer every single comment without skipping tough points. [Example reviewer response](#)
2. **Use a 3-part response structure:** (Comment → Author Response → Revised Manuscript Text)

Made-up example:

Reviewer 1, Comment 3: *"The authors claim that PFC stimulation drives gain control, but they did not report statistical power for the N=6 cohort."*

Author Response: We thank the reviewer for highlighting this oversight. We have now performed a post-hoc power analysis (Power = 0.88) and added a dedicated statistical breakdown in the Methods section.

Manuscript Revision (Page 12, Lines 245–250): *"A post-hoc power calculation confirmed that a sample size of N=6 was sufficient to detect..."*

3. **Make Changes Easy to Spot:** Highlight modified text in the revised manuscript using “track changes” or color-coded text.

AfricaArXiv

Free platform for sharing African research

- Not a journal and does not peer-review or assess the scientific quality of submissions

How to submit?

Submit your research through: <https://repository.africarxiv.org/>

The process has three main steps:

1. Create an account
2. Upload your research item
3. Add information about your submission (metadata)

For journal submissions, the safest version to upload is usually the manuscript version before journal peer review



[Submission guide](#)



Suggested exercise

Pick a journal that best fits your current research project

Write down 3 potential questions reviewers might ask you

Tip: check [eLife](#), or [PeerJ](#) for review examples

Example at [eLife](#), at [PeerJ](#) (corresponding [paper](#))



Suggested references

For journal selection and writing:

- [Taylor & Francis Publishing Journey Guides](#) (free download)
- [Ten common statistical mistakes to watch out for when writing or reviewing a manuscript](#)
- [PLOS Author Resources](#), [Taylor & Francis: How to publish your research](#)

Support for resource-constrained territories:

- [Taylor & Francis Support for researchers in resource-constrained countries](#)